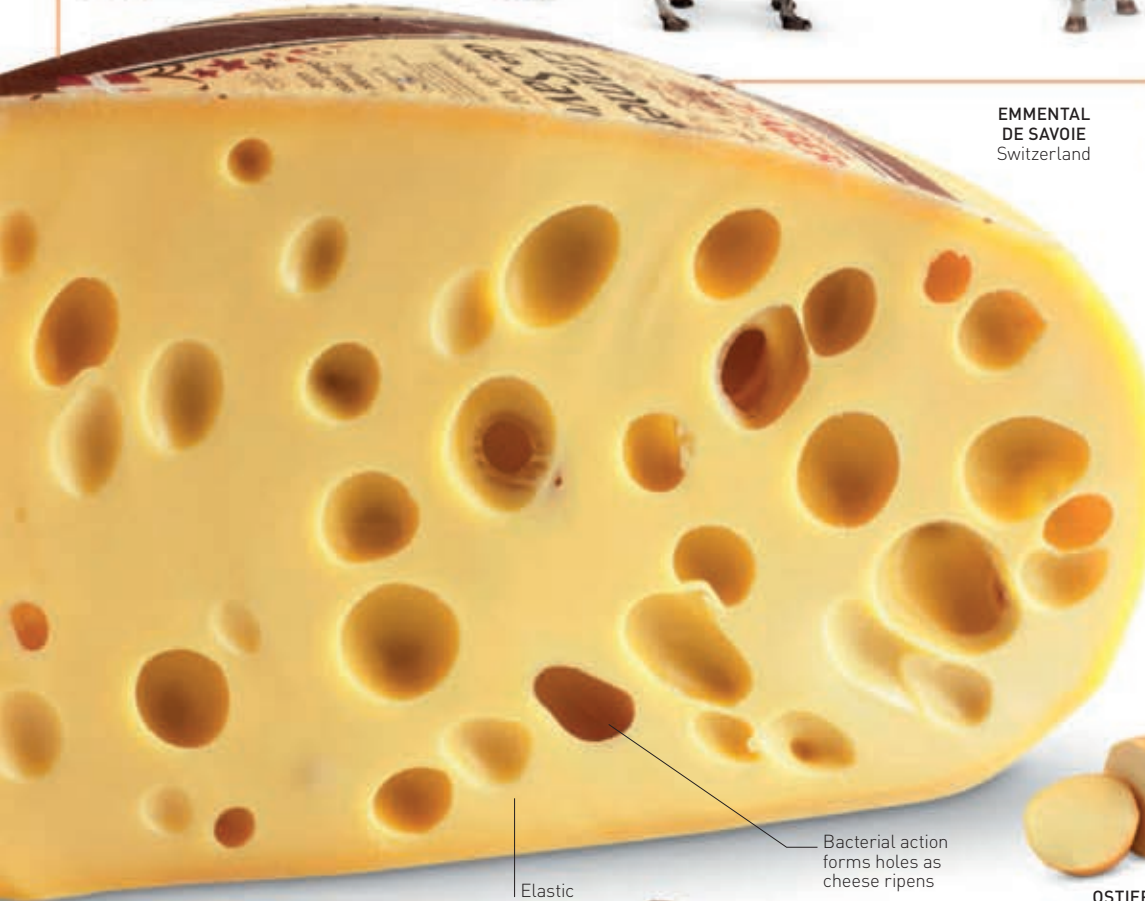


WHICH MILK MAKES CHEESE?

Most of the world's cheeses are made with milk from cows, goats, sheep, and buffalo. In dry regions with poor grazing, camels are an important source of milk. More rarely, cheese is made from the milk of horses, donkeys, yaks, and reindeer.



EMMENTAL
DE SAVOIE
Switzerland

Elastic
texture

Bacterial action
forms holes as
cheese ripens



GRAVIERA
Greece



TIROLER
GRAUKASE
Austria



PECORINO
SARDO
Italy



BITTO
Italy



MANCHEGO
Spain



PECORINO
ROMANO
Italy



GAMALOST
Norway



POSTEL
Belgium



CRESCENT DAIRY
FARMHOUSE
New Zealand



KASHKAVAL
Hungary



OSTIEPOK
Slovakia



SARDO
Argentina



ALLGAUER
BERGKASE
Germany



VASTERBOTTENSOST
Sweden



BAVARIA BLU
Germany



BLEU BENEDICTIN
Canada



BLEU DE CHEVRE
France



GAMONEDO
Spain



VALDEON
Spain



BARKHAM BLUE
UK



GORGONZOLA
Italy



STILTON
UK



ROQUEFORT
France

BLUE CHEESE

The mouldy-looking streaks running through blue cheeses really are mould – but a type that is safe to eat. To produce blue cheese, the makers add mould spores to the curdled milk. After shaping the cheese, they pierce, or “needle”, it to let in air and kickstart the mould’s growth. Blue cheese, which can be hard or soft, usually has a strong flavour.

CHEESE HISTORY

Cheese-making began long ago when people discovered, probably by chance, that curdled milk was good food. The cheese we eat today has a history of approximately 8,000 years.

4000 BCE
Evidence of dairy farming in the Sahara grasslands.

2000 BCE
Egyptian tomb paintings show cheese being made.

50 CE
The Romans invent the cheese press.

1791
French farmer Marie Harel invents Camembert cheese.

Statue of Marie Harel in Normandy, France

1348
First reference to cheese from Parma, later known as Parmesan.

1860S
Mass-produced rennet makes cheese-making more consistent.

8000 BCE



8000 BCE
People start keeping sheep and learn to milk them.

5500 BCE
Pots dating from this time in Europe may be the earliest cheese strainers.



3500 BCE
Sumerian clay writing tablets mention curd making.

Ancient Sumerian script

300 CE
Cheese is sold and eaten throughout Europe.

1170
First reference to Cheddar, from Somerset in England.



1697
First reference to Gouda, named after the Dutch town.
City Hall, Gouda

1815
First-ever cheese factory opens in Switzerland.

2011
A 939 kg (2,070 lb) goats cheese takes the world title for the biggest cheese ever.

2000